

Parallel Agent-Team Runbook

A practical guide to running multiple Claude Code sessions in parallel on this repo, each driven by a named lead working on a separate workstream without stepping on each other's files, branches, or memory.

This is the **runbook** — day-to-day operations. For the broader agent-teams overlay (teammate definitions, install, team shapes), see [AGENT_TEAMS_PLAYBOOK.md](#).

Mental model

Three decoupled concepts. Keeping them separate is what makes the system flexible.

Concept	What it is	Lives in
Lead	A named persona that owns a session's identity (Aria, Bram, Cleo, ...). Travels across workstreams.	.gauntlet/week2/kickoff/<name>.md (the kickoff prompt) + .claude/skills/<name>/SKILL.md (the slash command)
Workstream	A unit of work with its own branch + worktree + file ownership.	.gauntlet/week2/in-flight.md (the tracker) + git branch + worktree directory
Binding	Which lead is currently assigned to which workstream.	The Branch: and Worktree: lines inside the lead's kickoff file

The launcher reads the binding straight from the kickoff. To reassign, edit the kickoff. No script changes needed.

Current leads (snapshot — update as work shifts)

Lead	Workstream	Branch	Worktree	Kickoff
Aria	HITL extraction	agentforge/w2-hitl-extraction	../AgentForge-hitl	.gauntlet/week2/kickoff/aria.md
Bram	Eval suite + Thursday CI gate	agentforge/w2-eval-suite	../AgentForge-eval	.gauntlet/week2/kickoff/bram.md
Cleo	Patient Dashboard Modernization	agentforge/w2-dashboard-modernize	../AgentForge-dashboard	.gauntlet/week2/kickoff/cleo.md

The authoritative version of this table is in [.gauntlet/week2/in-flight.md](#). When that file changes, this snapshot should follow.

First-time setup

One-time: source the launcher in your shell profile

PowerShell — add to `$PROFILE`:

```
. C:\Dev\GauntletAI\AgentForge\scripts\lead-launchers.ps1
```

Bash (Git Bash on Windows / WSL / macOS / Linux) — add to `~/.bashrc`:

```
# Optional overrides:
# export AGENTFORGE_ROOT="$HOME/Dev/GauntletAI/AgentForge"
# export CURSOR_WORKSPACE_FILE="$HOME/AgentForge.code-workspace"
source /c/Dev/GauntletAI/AgentForge/scripts/lead-launchers.sh
```

Bash dependency: the launcher uses `jq` for workspace JSON manipulation. Git Bash bundles it in recent installers; WSL/Ubuntu: `sudo apt install jq`; macOS: `brew install jq`. PowerShell uses native JSON support, no extra install.

One-time: open the multi-root workspace in Cursor

The launcher manages `${parent}/AgentForge.code-workspace` (or whatever `CURSOR_WORKSPACE_FILE` points at) — adding worktrees on `Start-*` and removing them on `Stop-*`. The workspace file is created on first `Start-*` if it doesn't exist.

After your first `Start-Aria`, open the file in Cursor:

```
File → Open Workspace from File... → select AgentForge.code-workspace
```

Cursor remembers it for next time. From here on, every `Start-*` appears as a folder in your explorer; every `Stop-*` removes it.

Verify it works

```
# PowerShell
Get-Command Start-Aria
```

```
# bash
type start_aria
```

If you see the function definition, you're ready.

Daily operations

Start (or resume) a lead's session

```
Start-Aria      # PowerShell
```

```
start_aria      # bash
```

What happens:

1. Launcher reads `.gauntlet/week2/kickoff/aria.md` for the branch and worktree
2. If the worktree directory doesn't exist, it creates it (on a new or existing branch)
3. **Adds the worktree to AgentForge.code-workspace** (idempotent — no-op if already present).
Cursor's file explorer picks it up live.
4. **Sets the terminal tab title to Aria** so you can tell which lead this tab is running at a glance.
5. `cds` into the worktree
6. Launches `claude --agent gauntlet-team-lead --teammate-mode in-process` with the kickoff prompt as the first user message

Aria's session opens, reads `in-flight.md` and her handoff (if it exists), and proposes a team shape before any edits.

Resuming is the same command. The handoff file at `.gauntlet/week2/handoffs/aria-handoff.md` carries her prior context; the kickoff tells her to read it on session start.

Stop a lead's session (untrack from workspace)

```
Stop-Aria      # PowerShell
```

```
stop_aria      # bash
```

What happens:

1. Removes Aria's worktree from `AgentForge.code-workspace` — the folder disappears from Cursor's file explorer.
2. Resets the terminal tab title to `AgentForge`.
3. **Does not touch** the worktree directory, the branch, the handoff file, or any open Claude session — pure soft-stop.

`Start-Aria` later re-adds the worktree to the workspace and resumes.

For permanent cleanup after a merge, run `Stop-Aria` first, then `git worktree remove ../AgentForge-hitl` and `git branch -d agentforge/w2-hitl-extraction`.

Switch identity inside an already-running session

If you started a vanilla `claude` and want to assume a lead's identity without restarting, use the slash command:

```
/aria
/bram
/cleo
```

The skill loads the same kickoff content into the current session. Useful for ad-hoc questions or when you forgot to use the launcher.

End a session cleanly

Before `/clear` or closing the terminal, the lead should:

1. Write its handoff to `.gauntlet/week2/handoffs/<name>-handoff.md`
2. Update `.gauntlet/week2/in-flight.md` (status, files locked/unlocked, next checkpoint)
3. Commit + push if there's work to ship; otherwise leave the worktree dirty for the next session

The kickoff prompt instructs the lead to do this, but you can prompt it explicitly:

Write your handoff and update in-flight.md, then I'll close the session.

Reassigning a lead to new work

When a lead's current workstream merges (or you want to redirect mid-stream), just ask Claude:

Reassign Aria to the FHIR write-back hardening work. Branch `agentforge/w3-fhir-writeback`, worktree `../AgentForge-fhir`. Her PRD is at `.gauntlet/week3/fhir-writeback-prd.md`. She owns `interface/.../FhirObservationService.php` and the FHIR mapper tests.

What gets updated:

- `.gauntlet/week2/kickoff/aria.md` — Branch, Worktree, read-order, file ownership, first task
- `.gauntlet/week2/in-flight.md` — Aria's row in the Leads + File ownership tables
- (this `AGENT_TEAMS_RUNBOOK.md` snapshot if you want it kept fresh)

What stays put:

- Aria's handoff file (continuity across workstreams). Archive it if you want a fresh start: `mv .gauntlet/week2/handoffs/aria-handoff.md .gauntlet/week2/handoffs/_archived/aria-hitl-handoff.md`.
- The `aria` slash command — the skill is a thin pointer that just reads the kickoff, so it adapts automatically.
- The old worktree on disk. Clean up when you're sure: `git worktree remove ../AgentForge-hitl`.

Adding a new lead

Tell Claude:

Add a fourth lead, Dora. Workstream: production deployment hardening. Branch `agentforge/w2-deploy-hardening`, worktree `../AgentForge-deploy`. She owns `docker/**`, `bootstrap.sh`, and any `.gitlab-ci.yml` deploy stages (coordinate with Bram on the test stages).

What gets created:

- `.gauntlet/week2/kickoff/dora.md` — full kickoff with metadata + ownership + first task
- `.claude/skills/dora/SKILL.md` — `/dora` slash command pointer
- A row in `.gauntlet/week2/in-flight.md` Leads table

The launcher works without any script edit — `Start-Lead -Name "dora"` or `start_lead dora` runs immediately. If you want a `Start-Dora` convenience wrapper, ask and I'll add it to `scripts/lead-launchers.{ps1,sh}`.

Retiring a lead and cleaning up after a merge

When a workstream's branch merges:

1. **Confirm everything's on master** — `git log master --oneline -5` should show the merge commit.
2. **Remove the worktree** — `git worktree remove ../AgentForge-hitl`. Refuses if there are uncommitted changes; handle those first.
3. **Delete the branch** — `git branch -d agentforge/w2-hitl-extraction` (will refuse if not merged).
4. **Decide the lead's next move:**
 - Reassign to new work → see "Reassigning a lead" above
 - Retire entirely → remove the row from `in-flight.md` Leads, archive the kickoff (`mv .gauntlet/week2/kickoff/aria.md _archived/`), archive the skill if you want (`mv .claude/skills/aria _archived/`)

The handoff file stays in git history regardless — past context is preserved.

File map

```

AgentForge/
├── AGENT_TEAMS_PLAYBOOK.md      # The overlay (install, team shapes, teammate
roles)
├── AGENT_TEAMS_RUNBOOK.md      # This file – day-to-day parallel-lead
operations
├── CLAUDE.md                   # Project hard rules (read by all leads)
├── USERS.md                    # Personas + use cases (read by all leads)
├──
├── .claude/
│   ├── agents/                 # Teammate definitions (gauntlet-team-lead,
agent-rag, ...)
│   │   └── skills/
│   │       └── aria/SKILL.md    # /aria – load Aria's kickoff

```

```

|       |— bram/SKILL.md           # /bram
|       |— cleo/SKILL.md          # /cleo
|
|— scripts/
|   |— lead-launchers.ps1        # PowerShell: Start-Aria, Start-Bram, Start-
Cleo, Start-Lead
|   |— lead-launchers.sh          # Bash: start_aria, start_bram, start_cleo,
start_lead
|
|— .gauntlet/
|   |— week2/
|       |— in-flight.md           # Authoritative Leads table + ownership +
status
|       |— hitl-extraction-prd.md # Aria's PRD
|       |— prd.md                 # The W2 PRD (Bram reads $6+$7)
|       |— AgentForge – Clinical Co-Pilot W2 – Surprise Challenge_...pdf # Cleo's
requirements
|       |— kickoff/
|           |— aria.md             # Aria's kickoff (also the launcher's source
of truth)
|           |— bram.md
|           |— cleo.md
|       |— handoffs/
|           |— aria-handoff.md      # Written by Aria's sessions
|           |— bram-handoff.md
|           |— cleo-handoff.md

```

Coordination rules (hard)

These live in `.gauntlet/week2/in-flight.md` and apply to every parallel lead session. Repeated here for visibility.

1. **One owner per file.** A file appears under exactly one workstream in the ownership table. Other leads don't touch it.
2. **Shared files require coordination.** If two workstreams genuinely need the same file (e.g. `agent/main.py`), one PR at a time, agreed in `in-flight.md` before edits start.
3. **Schema migrations have a single owner.** The owning lead ships the migration; other leads rebase onto that branch when their queries need the new columns. No parallel migration work.
4. **Memory discipline.** Cross-cutting context lives in repo-tracked files, not in per-worktree memory banks:
 - Hard project rules + user prefs → `CLAUDE.md`, `USERS.md`
 - Cross-session decisions, in-progress state → per-lead handoff file
 - Lead-specific feedback → that lead's worktree memory bank (no sync)
5. **Read before editing.** First action of any session is to read `in-flight.md` plus the lead's own handoff. Last action before `/clear` or exit is to update both.

Troubleshooting

`git worktree add` fails with "fatal: " is already checked out"

The branch is already in another worktree. Either you have an existing session running, or you didn't clean up after a merge. Find it:

```
git worktree list
```

Remove the stale one if you're done with it:

```
git worktree remove ../AgentForge-hitl # refuses if dirty; commit/stash first
```

Worktree exists but on a different branch than the kickoff says

The launcher won't auto-fix this — it'll just `cd` into the existing worktree and launch. Either:

- Manually checkout the right branch: `cd ../AgentForge-hitl && git checkout <correct-branch>`
- Or remove + recreate: `git worktree remove ../AgentForge-hitl` then `Start-Aria` again

A lead writes to `./CLAUDE_SESSION_HANDOFF.md` instead of the per-lead handoff

The `session-handoff` skill defaults to that path. The kickoff explicitly overrides — but if the lead skipped reading the kickoff, it falls back to the default. Fix:

```
mv ../AgentForge-hitl/CLAUDE_SESSION_HANDOFF.md .gauntlet/week2/handoffs/aria-handoff.md
```

And remind the lead in the next session: "Your handoff goes to `.gauntlet/week2/handoffs/aria-handoff.md`, NOT the repo root."

Two leads accidentally edit the same file

`git diff` between the branches will show overlapping changes. Resolve the conflict at merge time as usual. Update `in-flight.md` ownership table to make the boundary explicit so it doesn't happen again.

Memory drift between leads (one lead "remembers" something the other doesn't)

Expected — by design, each worktree has its own memory dir. If the context is durable (a hard rule, a user preference), move it from the memory entry into `CLAUDE.md` or `USERS.md` so all leads see it via git.

Slash command `/aria` doesn't appear

Skills load from `.claude/skills/<name>/SKILL.md` — the directory layout matters. Flat `.claude/skills/<name>.md` files are silently ignored. If the skill exists but `/aria` doesn't appear, restart the Claude session (skills load at startup).

Launcher can't find the kickoff

```
Kickoff prompt not found at C:\...\gauntlet\week2\kickoff\aria.md
```

Either the file genuinely doesn't exist (create it) or your `AGENTFORGE_ROOT` is wrong. Check:

```
$AgentForgeRoot # PowerShell
```

```
echo $AGENTFORGE_ROOT # bash
```

Cursor doesn't show the new folder after `Start-*`

The launcher updated the workspace file, but Cursor cached the old folders list. Either:

- `Ctrl+Shift+P` → "Developer: Reload Window"
- Or close + reopen the workspace from the recent list

If the workspace itself isn't open in Cursor, you need to open it once: `File` → `Open Workspace from File...` → `AgentForge.code-workspace`. From then on, hot-reload usually works.

Terminal tab title doesn't change

The launcher emits the OSC 0 escape sequence which Cursor / VS Code / xterm-compatible terminals respect. If your tab title still shows the shell name (`pwsh`, `bash`), check:

- The terminal supports OSC 0 (most do; classic `cmd.exe` does not)
- Your shell prompt isn't overwriting the title every command (some custom prompts set the title to the cwd on every render — disable that or run the launcher in a shell without a title-setting prompt)

In Cursor specifically, you can also right-click the tab and "Rename..." manually as a fallback.

`jq: command not found` (bash only)

The bash launcher needs `jq` for JSON workspace edits. Install:

- Git Bash: reinstall Git for Windows (recent versions bundle `jq`)
- Ubuntu/WSL: `sudo apt install jq`
- macOS: `brew install jq`

PowerShell uses native JSON support and doesn't need `jq`.

Quick reference — most-used commands

```
# PowerShell
Start-Aria          # Launch / resume Aria; add worktree to workspace; title
tab "Aria"
Stop-Aria           # Untrack Aria from workspace; reset tab title
Start-Lead -Name "dora" # Launch any lead by name (no Start-Dora wrapper needed)
Stop-Lead  -Name "dora"

git worktree list      # See what's checked out where
git worktree remove ../AgentForge-hitl # Permanent cleanup after merge
```

```
# bash
start_aria          # Launch / resume Aria; add worktree to workspace; title
tab "Aria"
stop_aria           # Untrack Aria from workspace; reset tab title
start_lead dora      # Launch any lead by name
stop_lead  dora

git worktree list
git worktree remove ../AgentForge-hitl
```

In a running Claude session:

```
/aria          # Take on Aria's identity
/build-audit --scope coverage # Bram's first task
```

When asking Claude to manage leads:

"Reassign Aria to " "Add a fourth lead Dora for " "Retire Bram — eval suite is merged" "Update the in-flight tracker — Cleo finished the framework decision"

Pointers

- [AGENT_TEAMS_PLAYBOOK.md](#) — the broader overlay (teammate definitions, install, team shapes, when to call which teammate)
- [.gauntlet/week2/in-flight.md](#) — authoritative Leads table, file ownership, status; updated by every session
- [CLAUDE.md](#) — project hard rules every lead must honor
- [USERS.md](#) — personas + use cases
- [.gauntlet/week2/hitl-extraction-prd.md](#) — Aria's PRD (example of a workstream-scoped product spec)